SOMIAH
GROUP

ADMIN GUIDE

Somasu

Setting up, family members, notifications, releases and troubleshooting

PREPARED BY	Andrew Somiah
PREPARED FOR	Somasu admins
DATE	12 November 2026
VERSION	v19 · app 26 R11

Contents

What admins do 3

How Somasu is put together 3

Free plan limits 4

Setting up Somasu 5

1. Supabase: the database 5
2. Supabase: sign-in settings 5
3. GitHub and Netlify: the website 5
4. Notification keys 6
5. Connect the app 6

Family members 7

Bookings, calendars and bin day 8

Things to book 8

Linked calendars 8

Bin day 8

Notifications behind the scenes 9

Releasing a new version 11

Every release 11

Backups and data 11

Troubleshooting 12

Checklist 12

What admins do

Admins look after Somasu for the family: adding and removing family members, setting up the pieces behind it and putting out new versions. Day to day, admins use Somasu like everyone else; the User guide covers that. This guide covers everything else.

Admin job	How often	Page
Set up Somasu (the database, website and notifications)	Once	5
Add or remove a family member	Now and then	7
Add things to book, help with linked calendars	Now and then	8
Check bin day against the council's new calendar	Each March	8
Release a new version	When there's a change	11
Check it's healthy	Monthly	12

How Somasu is put together

Somasu is a web app: a website that installs like an app. Three free services run it, Netlify and Supabase are on the **SomiahDev@proton.me** login, which is for set-up only; the code is on the family's one GitHub account, absomiah-dev, which St Kenelm's also uses. Nobody signs in to Somasu itself with that address.

Service	What it does	Why it's separate
GitHub (absomiah-dev)	Keeps the code and every version of it, in a private repository (a code folder with history).	Shared with St Kenelm's on purpose: GitHub only stores code, so nothing one app does can switch the other off. Private repositories are free and unlimited.
Netlify	Hosts the website and runs five small server programs (functions): linked calendars, notifications, reminders, family sign-ins and weather.	Its own account so Somasu never uses up the St Kenelm's credits. If one site runs out, Netlify pauses every site on that account.
Supabase	The database (lists, events, bookings, family) and sign-in (email and password).	A clean account for family apps, separate from school data.

The code lives in My Projects/Somiah-Family-App/01_Site. The web app itself is in public/; the server functions are in netlify/functions/.

The barcode scanner (26 R9) needs no account or key: product names come from Open Food Facts, a free product database looked up by barcode number, and phones that can't read barcodes themselves (iPhone) use ZXing, a free barcode reader kept in public/vendor/. Compare prices just opens Trolley.co.uk.

The Weather tile on Home (26 R10) uses Open-Meteo, a free forecast service for personal use, with no account or key. Only the town's rough location (Witney) is sent, never the address; each phone asks at most once an hour. To change the town, edit WEATHER_PLACE near the dashboard code in public/app.js.

Weather warnings and the look-ahead (26 R11) come from the server function weather, which runs every 30 minutes. It reads the Met Office warnings RSS feed for London & South East England (free; the terms ask for a link to each full warning and a credit, both shown in the app) and, every 6 hours, the Open-Meteo ensemble (15 days, 51 runs) and seasonal (weeks 3 to 6) forecasts for Witney. It saves them in the family settings (rows weather_warnings, weather_outlook; weather_sent records what has been sent) and notifies everyone once about each new warning and each firm heads-up, never between 10pm and 7am. Phones only read the saved results.

Free plan limits

- **Netlify:** 300 credits a month. Each live release costs 15 credits; test copies (deploy previews) are free. Reminders (and bin day) run every 5 minutes and use a few credits a month.
- **Supabase:** two free projects per person. Free projects pause after 7 quiet days, but the reminders check every 5 minutes keeps Somasu's awake.
- **Emails:** people sign in with a password, so Somasu only sends emails for password resets. Supabase's built-in email sends a few an hour and new free projects can't change its wording (June 2026 change). Connecting a free email sender (SMTP, for example Brevo) would lift both limits if it ever matters.

Setting up Somasu

Do these once, in this order. Claude can do the GitHub and Netlify parts with you; the Supabase steps are done in the Supabase dashboard because it's on its own account.

1. Supabase: the database

1. Sign in to Supabase with the SomiahDev login. **New project**, name it **somasu**, region **London (eu-west-2)**, set a strong database password and save it in your password manager.
2. Open **SQL Editor › New query**. Paste the whole of 02_Database-Setup/...Database-setup-v6.sql.
3. Check the box at the top: the first admin's name and the email **you'll sign in with** (not the SomiahDev address). Click **Run**. It ends with "Somasu database ready (v6)". It's safe to run again.
4. Go to **Project Settings › API** (or API Keys). Note the **Project URL**, the **publishable** key and the **secret** key. The secret key never goes in the app, in chat or in an email.

2. Supabase: sign-in settings

Where	Set it to	Why
Authentication › Sign In / Providers › Email	Allow new users to sign up: **off**. Minimum password length **10**; requirements **lowercase, uppercase letters and digits**	Only people you add can sign in; same password rule as the app checks.
Authentication › URL Configuration	Site URL: the Netlify address (step 3)	So password-reset links open Somasu.
Authentication › Users › Add user	Your own sign-in email and a real password (in your password manager), **Auto confirm** ticked	Supabase's sign-in list. The script already made you Somasu's first admin on the family list.

3. GitHub and Netlify: the website

1. Create a private repository **somasu** on the absomiah-dev GitHub account and put the contents of 01_Site in it (Claude can do this).
2. Sign in to Netlify with the SomiahDev login. **Add new site › Import from Git › GitHub**, allow Netlify to see the absomiah-dev account's **somasu** repository only, and pick it. Build settings come from netlify.toml; leave them as they are.
3. Site name: **somasu** (so the address is somasu.netlify.app).

4. Add the environment variables below (**Site configuration › Environment variables**), then deploy.

Variable	Value
SUPABASE_URL	The Project URL from Supabase
SUPABASE_KEY	The publishable key
SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY	The secret key (server only; lets the functions send notifications and reminders)
VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY / VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY	The notification keys (step 4)
VAPID_SUBJECT	mailto:SomiahDev@proton.me

4. Notification keys

Notifications need a matching pair of keys (VAPID keys: the public half goes in the app, the private half stays on the server). Ask Claude to make a pair, or run npx web-push generate-vapid-keys on a computer with Node installed. Put both in Netlify (step 3) and the public key in config.js.

5. Connect the app

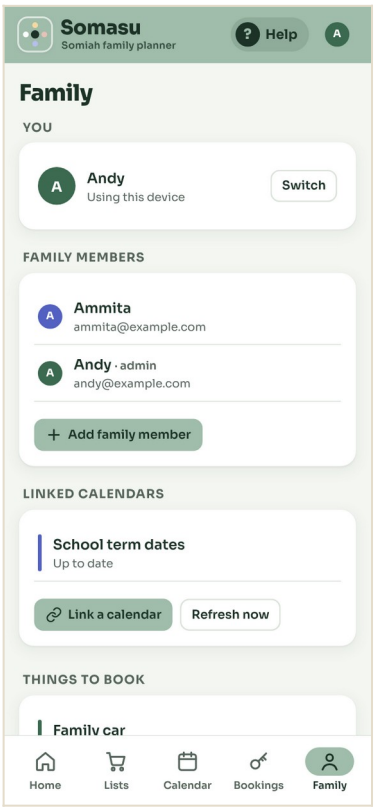
Edit public/config.js and fill in **supabaseUrl**, **supabaseKey** (publishable) and **vapidPublicKey**. Commit the change; Netlify publishes it. Open the site, sign in with your email and password, and check your name shows on Home.

> **KEEP SECRETS SECRET**
>
> The secret key and the private notification key live only in Netlify's environment variables and your password manager. If one is ever exposed, make a new one in Supabase (or new notification keys) and update Netlify.

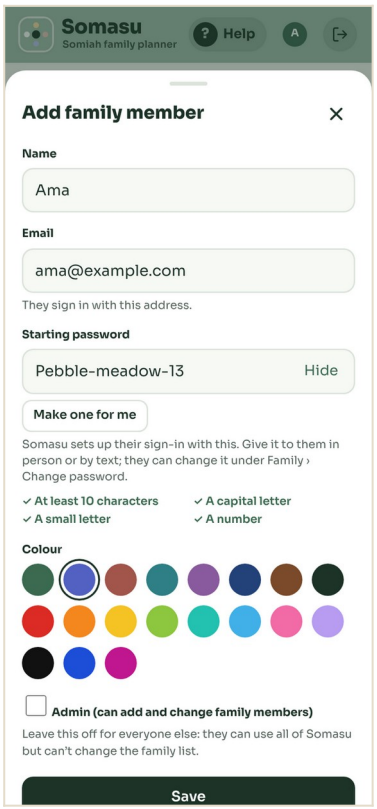
Family members

Adding someone is now one step: Somasu sets up their sign-in for you (from 26 R9), so there's nothing to do in Supabase.

1. **Family › Add family member.** Their name, the email they'll sign in with, a starting password (tap Make one for me for an easy-to-read one) and a colour. Leave Admin off unless they should manage the family list.
2. **Save.** Somasu creates their sign-in straight away, already confirmed, with no admin rights. If that email already has a sign-in, Somasu leaves its password as it is.
3. Send them the link and the User guide, and give them the starting password in person or by text (not in the same message as the link). They can change it under Family › Change password. Every password box has a Show button, so they can check what they've typed.



Family members



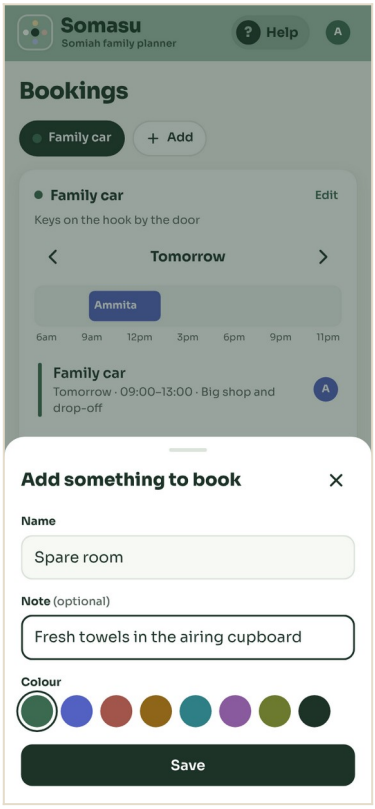
Add a family member

To remove someone, tap them in Family members and choose Remove: Somasu removes their sign-in too. Their past items and events stay. If someone forgets their password, tap them, type a New starting password and Save. Changing someone's email moves their sign-in to the new address. Somasu always keeps at least one admin and won't let you remove yourself.

Bookings, calendars and bin day

Things to book

Anyone can add something to book (Bookings › Add, or Family › Things to book): a name, a note such as where the keys are, and a colour. Deleting one also deletes its bookings, so Somasu asks first. Double bookings are blocked twice: in the app, and again in the database, so two phones booking the same slot at the same second can't both succeed.



Add something to book

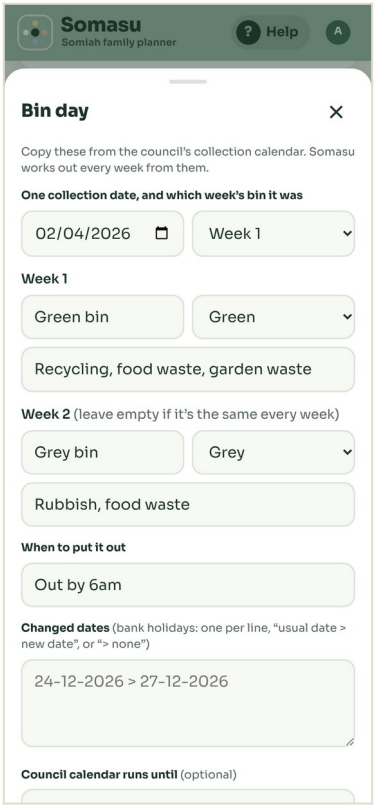
Linked calendars

Anyone can link a calendar (User guide, Family and settings). Netlify fetches the calendar for the app, because Google, Outlook and Apple don't let a web page read them directly. Only signed-in family members can use it; it fetches any public https address (so school and club calendars work), refuses private-network and local addresses, and only passes back real calendars. If a calendar shows ⚠️, the link has usually been reset at the source: copy a fresh one and link it again.

Bin day

Somasu shows which bin goes out on Home and in the calendar, and the reminders job sends a notification at 7pm the evening before. It works from a rule, not a list of dates: one known collection, the weekday, and the bins in turn (green one week, grey the next), plus

any bank holiday changes. Set it up or change it under **Family › Bin day** (admins only), copying from the council's calendar.



Family › Bin day

Our settings (West Oxfordshire, Thursday 1 round): one collection date **2 April 2026, Week 1**; Week 1 Green bin, recycling, food waste, garden waste; Week 2 Grey bin, rubbish, food waste; out by 6am; council link westoxon.gov.uk › Bins and recycling › Waste calendars › Thu1. Changed dates go one per line, like **24-12-2026 > 27-12-2026**, or **> none** for a collection that doesn't happen.

Somasu never reads the council website itself: it blocks automatic visitors, and there is no public data feed. Instead, the scheduled update check reads the new calendar each March, compares it with the rule and emails you any changed dates to type in. You can also send Claude the new PDF. The rule lives in the family settings (app_settings, row **bins**); the row **bins_reminded** records the last reminder so it is only sent once.

Notifications behind the scenes

What happens	Who gets it	Sent by
Items added to a list (gathered up for 45 seconds)	Everyone else with Lists on	notify function, right after the change

What happens	Who gets it	Sent by
Event added, changed or cancelled	The people it's for (or everyone), except whoever made the change	notify function
Booking made, changed or cancelled	Everyone else with Bookings on	notify function
Event reminder	The people it's for, with Reminders on	reminders function, every 5 minutes
Bin day, the evening before	Everyone with Bin day on	reminders function, at 7pm
Weather warnings and heads-ups	Everyone with Weather on	weather function, every 30 minutes (not 10pm to 7am)

Each device that turns notifications on is saved in the push_subscriptions table with its own choices. People can only see their own devices. Devices that stop working (a reset phone, say) are removed automatically the next time something is sent. Sent reminders are logged in reminders_sent so none goes twice, and the log clears itself after 30 days.

Scheduled functions only run on the live site, never on test copies. In Netlify, **Logs › Functions › reminders** shows a line every 5 minutes, such as "3 with reminders, 0 due, 0 sent".

Releasing a new version

Somasu follows the same version rule as St Kenelm's and Vitro Expenses: the two-digit year plus a release number. Test builds before go-live are **R0.1, R0.2…**; going live is **26 R1**; every release after that adds one. The first release of 2027 is 27 R1.

Every release

1. In public/app.js, change APP_RELEASE and APP_UPDATED, and add the release at the top of RELEASES: one short plain-English sentence per change, under **everyone** (what the family will notice) and **admin** (set-up changes).
2. In public/index.html, update the app-version line; in public/sw.js, change the CACHE name to match (this makes phones fetch the new files).
3. If the guides change, update them, export the PDFs into public/guides/ and check the page numbers in the GUIDES list in app.js. If a screen in a video changes, re-record the videos with the script in 07_Videos (they go in public/guides/videos/, listed in VIDEOS in app.js).
4. Push to a test branch first. Netlify builds a free test copy (deploy preview); check it.
5. When it's right, merge to main. That's the live release (15 credits). Open the live site and check the version line and What's new.

> **IF THE DATABASE CHANGES**
>
> Run the new setup script in Supabase **before** releasing the app that needs it. The scripts upgrade in place and never delete data.

Backups and data

Anyone can download a backup from Family › Your data. Supabase's free plan doesn't keep automatic backups you can restore, so download one now and then (monthly is plenty) and keep it in OneDrive. The database is in London. Somasu stores names, email addresses, list items, events, bookings and linked calendar links; nothing is shared outside the family.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Check
“Can’t reach the family database”	Supabase dashboard: is the project paused? Restore it. Then check the Netlify reminders log is running (it keeps the project awake).
Someone can sign in but sees “Nearly there”	Their sign-in and family entry don’t match. Tap them in Family members, type a New starting password and Save: Somasu sets their sign-in up again.
Someone can’t sign in or has forgotten their password	Ask them to tap Show in the password box to check what they typed (and, on a computer, look for the red “Caps Lock is on” note). If it’s really forgotten, they use Forgotten your password? on the sign-in page. If the email doesn’t come, in Supabase › Authentication › Users open their row and send a password recovery, or delete and re-add them with a new starting password (their Somasu data stays).
Nobody gets notifications	Family › Notifications › Send me a test says what’s wrong. “Secret key is wrong”: copy the secret key from Supabase › Project Settings › API Keys into SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY in Netlify. “Refused (code 403)”: the VAPID keys in Netlify don’t match the one in config.js. “No device”: turn notifications off and on again. Netlify only uses a changed setting after the next deploy. Netlify › Logs › Functions › notify shows the details.
Reminders don’t arrive	Netlify › Logs › Functions › reminders: running every 5 minutes? Is the event’s reminder set, and is it for the right people?
A linked calendar shows ⚠️	The link was reset or the calendar made private at the source. Copy a fresh link and link it again; unlink the old one.
Phones show an old version	Was the CACHE name in sw.js changed? Close and reopen the app.
Netlify says out of credits	Sites are paused until the month resets. Fewer live releases; use free test copies.

Checklist

A quick monthly check, five minutes:

- Open Somasu: lists, calendar and bookings load, and the version line is right.
- Family › Notifications › Send me a test arrives.

- Netlify › Logs › Functions › reminders shows recent runs; credits used this month look normal.
- Supabase project is active (not paused) and the database size is well under the free limit.
- Linked calendars show “Up to date”.
- Download a backup and save it to OneDrive.
- Anyone who’s left the family list removed from both Somasu and Supabase.